THE WAR ROOM JOURNAL

14TH JANUARY 2027 THE CONSTITUENCY SERIES · GRENADA ELECTION 2026 VOL. 11 OF 15

VOL. 11 · ST. GEORGE SOUTH EAST

After Bowen: The Second Test in St. George South East

Gregory Bowen, a former Deputy Prime Minister, lost St. George South East in 2022. In 2026 the NNP tried a new candidate, and the result was worse: a margin of 1,294, no polling divisions, and a fall in the NNP's share faster than the national swing.

BY GREG HOSTEN ST. GEORGE SOUTH EAST, GRENADA

ST. GEORGE SOUTH EAST, GRENADA— For a generation, St. George South East meant Gregory Bowen. He represented the seat for the NNP over many years, served as Deputy Prime Minister and later as the party's deputy chairman. In 2022 he lost it to the NDC's Phillip Telesford by 2,122 votes to 1,634.

"A known name softened the fall. A new one did not."
GREG HOSTEN

The 2026 election was the NNP's second test in the seat, and its first without Mr. Bowen on the ballot. Mr. Telesford took 2,464 votes to 1,170 for the NNP's Dwight Horsford, with 66 for the DPM's Stanford Simon and 10 for the GULP. A deficit of 488 became 1,294.

A SEAT THAT HAS SWUNG BEFORE

St. George South East, which runs from Springs and Calivigny through La Borie, Morne Jaloux, St. Paul's and Hope Vale, is not a natural stronghold for either party. Mr. Bowen lost it once before, in 2008, to the NDC's Karl Hood, and won it back in 2013.

That history matters. A seat that has swung both ways can swing back. But it swings towards the party that is present, and in 2026 the numbers suggest the NNP was not.

WORSE THAN THE NATIONAL SWING

The NNP's vote fell by 464, from 1,634 to 1,170. Mr. Telesford's rose by 342. The NNP's share of the two-party vote dropped from 43.5 per cent to 32.2 per cent, a fall of 11.3 points, one point worse than the national swing.

In seats where the NNP's candidate was a familiar name, such as St. John and St. Andrew North East, the party fell by less than the national average. In St. George South East, with a new candidate, it fell by more. The pattern is consistent with the rest of this series: a known name softened the fall, and a new one did not.

THE INCUMBENT WHO CONSOLIDATED

Mr. Telesford entered the 2026 campaign after four years as the sitting member. His share of the whole electorate rose from 39.2 per cent of registered voters to 42.1 per cent, one of the clearest signs in any seat of an incumbent strengthening his position.

The NNP's share of the electorate fell from 30.2 per cent to 20.0 per cent. In four years the party lost a third of its voters in a seat it had held for most of the previous two decades.

NOT ONE DIVISION

The NNP did not carry any of the 20 polling divisions. Its best result was at the Springs Open Bible Church, where it took 39.3 per cent of the two-party vote across two divisions. The Anglican High School division gave it 38.7 per cent, and La Borie, across three divisions, 36.4 per cent.

Its weakest areas were stark. At the Calivigny Community Centre the NNP took 21.8 per cent across two divisions, and in one of them just 26 votes to the NDC's 107. At Hope Vale it took 23.3 per cent. At St. Paul's Anglican Church, across three divisions, 28.7 per cent.

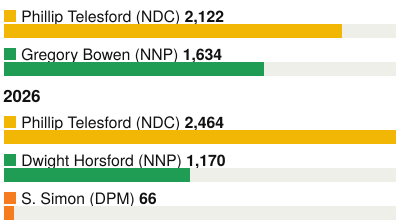
FEWER VOTERS, AGAIN

The register grew by 443 names, but 81 fewer ballots were cast. Turnout fell from 70.2 per cent to 63.5 per cent, and 2,137 registered voters did not vote, up from 1,613.

The DPM took 66 votes, one of its better results outside the Town. Even if all of them had gone to the NNP, the margin would still have been more than 1,200. As in most seats outside the Town of St. George, the split was not the problem.

2022 VS 2026

Votes by candidate, in party colours



1,294 votes
NDC winning margin in 2026

BY THE NUMBERS

1,294
NDC winning margin, up from 488 in 2022

0 of 20
Polling divisions won by the NNP

–11.3 pts
Fall in the NNP's two-party share, worse than nationally

–464
Fall in the NNP vote since 2022

SIX HUNDRED AND FORTY-EIGHT VOTERS

To have won the seat, the NNP needed 648 voters to switch sides, or 1,295 more of its own supporters to turn out, three in five of those who stayed home. That is a large gap for one election.

But St. George South East has swung before, and the NNP's 2022 vote of 1,634 is the natural first target. Recovering it would cut the deficit by more than a third and make the seat competitive again by 2030/31.

WHAT CAN BE DONE: A FOUR-YEAR PLAN FOR THE SOUTH-EAST

St. George South East needs a candidate with time to become known, and a party that treats the seat as winnable again.

Year one, 2027: choose the candidate early and commit to that person for two elections. If Mr. Horsford stands again, fund an office and an organiser. Ask Mr. Bowen and other former members of the branch to help introduce the candidate across the constituency: a public handover, even years late, is better than none.

Year two, 2028: build out from Springs, La Borie and the Anglican High School area, where the NNP did best. Hold regular meetings in Morne Jaloux and the Marian area, and with young families and workers along the Calivigny corridor. Register new voters every month.

Year three, 2029: recruit a captain for each of the 20 divisions. Give special attention to Calivigny, Hope Vale and St. Paul's, where the NNP fell below 30 per cent, because no seat can be won while whole communities are written off.

Year four, 2030: set targets in order. Win the first polling division. Restore the 2022 vote of 1,634. Bring the NNP's share of the two-party vote back above 40 per cent. Those three steps would put the seat back in play.

THE LESSON FOR EVERY NNP SEAT

When a long-serving member loses, the party has two choices: rebuild around them or rebuild around someone new. Either can work. What does not work is a new candidate named late, without the old member's visible support and without time to build a base.

St. George South East, like St. Mark and St. George North West, shows that how the NNP handles succession decides seats. The party should write down its succession rules and apply them in every constituency, starting now.

THE ARITHMETIC OF ST. GEORGE SOUTH EAST

Measure	2022	2026	Change
NNP votes	1,634	1,170	−464
NDC votes	2,122	2,464	+342
NNP share of two-party vote	43.5%	32.2%	−11.3 pts
NNP two-party share nationally	48.0%	37.7%	−10.3 pts
Winning margin	NDC +488	NDC +1,294	
Registered voters	5,413	5,856	+443
Ballots cast	3,800	3,719	−81
Turnout	70.2%	63.5%	−6.7 pts
Registered voters who did not vote	1,613	2,137	+524
NNP votes as a share of all registered voters	30.2%	20.0%	−10.2 pts
Polling divisions won by the NNP		0 of 20	
Switchers the NNP needed to win		648	

Two-party figures exclude minor candidates (2022: IFP 32, GRP 4; 2026: DPM 66, GULP 10). 2026 figures are provisional results from the Parliamentary Elections Office, all 20 polling divisions verified.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR 2030/31

1. Plan succession: a new name, named late, fell faster than the national swing.
2. Use former members to introduce new candidates in public.
3. A swing seat swings towards the party that is present.
4. Build out from Springs and La Borie, the NNP's best ground.
5. Do not write off Calivigny, Hope Vale or St. Paul's.
6. Register new voters monthly: 443 joined the roll, fewer people voted.
7. Captain all 20 divisions and win the first one.
8. Restore the 2022 vote of 1,634 as the first milestone.

Sources: Parliamentary Elections Office live results, live.elections.gd (2026, provisional; polling divisions read 9 Nov 2026); Wikipedia (2008 and 2022 general elections); NOW Grenada (NNP caretakers, 2017; NNP convention, Dec 2024; 2026 results). Analytics computed by the author from the published counts. Analysis by Greg Hosten, Vol. 11 of a weekly constituency series. Written in the style of a newspaper report; not a publication of any news organisation.